

KRISHNAN GANESH

46, ONLINE ENTREPRENEUR
FOUNDER, TUTORVISTA.COM
INITIAL INVESTMENT IN 2005 Rs 40 lakh
CURRENT TURNOVER Rs 59 crore

role MODELS

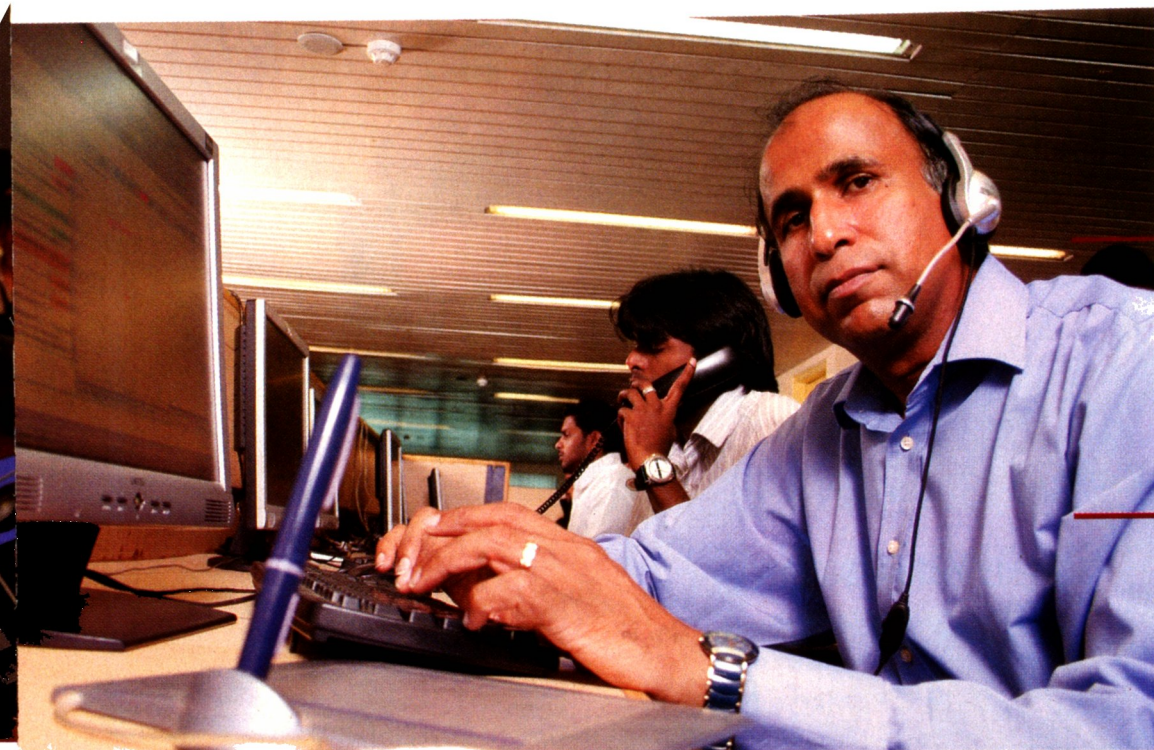
Sunil Mittal, Shiv
Nadar and his mother
Seethalakshmi

turning POINT

A newspaper cartoon
in the US making fun of
outsourcing to India

biggest OBSTACLE

Getting the world to
trust an Internet-based
Indian business model



SANJAY RAMACHANDRAN

TEACHING AMERICA

In the dark of the night and the wee hours of the morning, while most of India sleeps, there are nearly 900 teachers spread across 93 locations in India hooked on their headphones, connected to their PCs and broadband, tutoring school and college students, 90 per cent of whom are based in the United States of America. Ironically, the credit for this unique concept of online tutoring goes to a newspaper cartoon in America. "There was a cartoon where an American parent was telling his child that he could not outsource his homework to India. That got me thinking, and I realised that there was a big market waiting to be tapped," says Krishnan Ganesh, serial entrepreneur and founder of TutorVista.com.

With the knowledge that private tutors charged anything between \$30 and \$40 an hour, something that average Americans could not afford, Ganesh set up a system

where Indian teachers would tutor students for a subscription of \$100 a month. TutorVista.com started operations in a one-room incubation centre at the Indian Institute of Information Technology, Bangalore, in April 2006 with just five employees and 25 tutors. In two years, it has grown to 1,200 employees and reaches out to 10,000 students across the world.

"All our marketing is now targeted at the US, yet we have 700 students from Korea and a handful from Britain and other countries," says Ganesh. Future expansion plans include Australia, Canada, China, Argentina and Mexico. Also on the cards are add-on services like tax planning, administrative help and other value-added services. "There is a market out there for all this and more," he says. That should make Dilbert think twice before joking about the Indian outsourcing industry.

by Nirmala Ravindran

**UNLIKE MOST BPOS
WHOSE CLIENTS ARE
OTHER COMPANIES**

BASED ABROAD,
TUTORVISTA.COM
IS A B2C, WHERE IT
REACHES OUT
DIRECTLY TO THE
END CONSUMER,
IN THIS CASE,
PARENTS AND
STUDENTS.